Thapa's men get butchered across the Pangong Tso. In the case of Srijap, the massive body of water had isolated the 1/8 GR positions, but the same cannot be said of Rezang-la. The Chinese build-up in the area of Spanggur Tso was clearly visible and it should have been obvious that both the Gurung Hill post and Rezang-la would be targeted. Shaitan Singh's company was deployed at Rezang-la but nothing was done to either give 13 Kumaon's Charlie Company any depth in the eventuality of a Chinese assault or even secure communications for that matter.

Radio Peking's announcement on 24 October after the Chinese had captured all their objectives in the Northern Sector that Chushul was the next target sent both Western Command and Army HQ into a tizzy. To capture Chushul they would have to cross the claim line, which implied that even Leh was being threatened.

On 18 November, Commander 114 Brigade was willing to fight to the finish, yet twenty-four hours later, all fighting posts were called back and the heavy equipment evacuated from the Chushul theatre of operations. Just who pulled the plug in Ladakh continues to remain a mystery. Sometime towards the end of October, Daulet Singh had had an operational briefing in Army HQ wherein he had outlined his plans for the defence of Chushul to Thapar. Subsequently, despite being outranked, Palit, as the DMO, had taken it upon himself to criticize the plan, pointing out what he called the 'strategic weakness of Chushul'. In light of the Chinese stated objective of capturing the Chushul airfield, Palit had quite forcefully argued that the Chinese threat to Leh was even greater than that faced by Tawang. Not only were the Chushul defences tactically poorly sited, the DMO said that, in all likelihood, the Chinese would cut off and isolate the brigade while making straight for Leh along the Indus route. In his opinion, it was necessary to abandon Chushul and fall back on Leh.

With Thapar seemingly buying the argument, the normally unflappable Daulet Singh had become enraged. However, he did not raise his voice but sensibly countered Palit's argument by pointing out that the Chinese had not crossed their claim line either at Srijap or at Demchok; in his opinion, they were unlikely to attack Chushul. Should they do so, the army commander had told Palit and Thapar, the defences at Chushul were quite capable of keeping the Chinese at bay. After Daulet Singh had left, Thapar told Palit that he did not overrule the army commander because he too had a 'gut feeling' that the Chinese would not actually cross the claim line.